

Before we move on, it is essential to clarify why anyone would want L1 analysts to write reports in addition to marking them as True or False Positives and why this topic can not be underestimated. Having L1 analysts write alert reports serves several key purposes:

Alert Report Purpose	Explanation
Provide context for escalation	• A well-written report saves lots of time for L2 analysts • Also, it helps them quickly understand what happened
Save findings for the records	• Raw <u>SIEM</u> logs are stored for 3-12 months, but alerts are kept indefinitely • As a result, it's better to keep all the context inside the alert, just in case
Improve investigation skills	• If you can't explain it simply, you don't understand it well enough • Report writing is a great way to boost L1 skills by summarising alerts

Report Format



Imagine yourself as an L2 analyst, a DFIR team member, or an IT professional who needs to understand the alert. What would you want to see in the report? We recommend you follow the **Five Ws** approach and include at least these items in the report:

ALERT REPORT CHECKLIST

Double-Extension File Creation

Status

Completed

Verdict

True Positive